

The Nexus 9

Five years after the first Nexus device (only two since the first Nexus tablet however) found people setting certain high expectations for a Nexus. Even though most Nexus devices had extremely great hardware for the prices, Google's dream was all about showcasing the beauty of stock Android. The spec sheet was just a bonus that just sort of happened. And this was definitely most evidenced by the fourth (and final) Nexus tablet – the Nexus 9. It was announced on 15th October, 2014 and this time around, Google partnered up with HTC to deliver the tablet.

The Nexus 9, to be extremely candid, felt very lazy about the external design language. It looked pretty much like a scaled up Nexus 5 with a few



A scaled up Nexus 5

elements changed to differentiate the two. Not that we are calling the 5's design bad – far from it. We just wish that HTC gave a little more care into designing the final Nexus tablet. The Nexus 9 had a 2048×1536 screen resolution with a pixel density of 281 ppi and packed a Nvidia Tegra K1 processor coupled with 2 gigs of RAM under the hood. The whole tablet, while felt very good when put together, was nothing extremely spectacular and public reception showed that.

The real star of the show was the software. The Nexus 9 shipped with Android 5.0 Lollipop, the first major overhaul of Android. Gone was the cold and Stark days of mini-

malistic design, the new 'Material Design' incorporated into Lollipop was full of vibrant colors and over exaggerated motion. Along with the performance tweaks, Lollipop offered a user experience that was heads and shoulders above any previous version of Android. Coupled with the very snappy Tegra processor, doing pretty much anything on the Nexus 9 was a breeze. In fact, the processor was so powerful that even Lollipop failed to utilize it to its fullest potential. It was an interesting quandary – pretty much every tablet at the time used quad core SoCs while the Tegra K1 was a dual core and